

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR RECRUITMENT TO THE POST OF
ASSISTANT CONTROLLER OF MINES
UNDER COMMERCE & INDUSTRIES DEPARTMENT,
GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(AUGUST-2026)

GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

PART-A

(34 Marks)

*This section should be answered only on the Answer Sheet provided.
Marks for each question is indicated against it. Attempt all questions.*

1. Write a précis of the following passage. (14)

Exploration and quarrying operations in the North-Eastern hill regions, particularly in states like Mizoram, encounter unique structural and environmental vulnerabilities that distinguish them from mining activities in mainland Indian plateaus. The combination of steep terrain, high-intensity monsoon rainfall, and young, seismically active geological formations creates a high-risk environment for standard extraction methods. Minor minerals, primarily sandstone and stone boulders used for regional infrastructure, are frequently extracted through small-scale, fragmented quarrying units.

Unfortunately, these units often lack the engineering capacity to manage high vertical faces, leading to frequent slope failures and landslides that endanger both labour and nearby settlements. Furthermore, the practice of stone crushing near highway corridors generates significant particulate matter, which degrades air quality and settles on surrounding vegetation, causing long-term agricultural distress.

To mitigate these localized hazards, mining administrative bodies must mandate systematic terracing and bench-formation protocols tailored specifically to steep slopes. It is no longer sufficient to regulate mineral revenue alone; the administration must actively oversee the hydrological impact of quarrying. Proper drainage networks must be constructed around lease areas to prevent rainwater accumulation from liquefying the soil overburden. Furthermore, the District Mineral Foundation (DMF) funds must be strategically utilized to rehabilitate abandoned quarry sites through targeted afforestation and loose-boulder check dams. Balancing the accelerating demand for construction aggregates with the ecological preservation of fragile hill slopes represents the defining administrative challenge for modern mining controllers in the region.

While Mizoram is not characterized by large-scale heavy metalliferous deposits like the iron or coal belts of central India, its unique inventory of non-metallic resources, including high-grade sandstone, shale, and potential clay deposits, forms the backbone of its localized industrial growth. The strategic position of the state, serving as a gateway for trans-national infrastructure projects like the Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport Project, has exponentially escalated the domestic consumption of these structural minerals.

However, translating this resource wealth into equitable economic development requires a departure from ad-hoc extraction practices. The state's mineral policy must prioritize structured resource appraisal over hasty extraction to ensure long-term availability. Unregulated quarrying not only causes revenue leakage through illegal transport networks but also prevents the state from commanding fair market value for its natural assets.

To rectify this, the modern mining administration must deploy digital monitoring tools, such as drone-based volumetric surveys and electronic transit passes, to plug leakage and accurately map the depletion rates of active stone quarries. Simultaneously, economic growth must not alienate local communities. Under the current mineral governance paradigms, sustainable development requires that a portion of the royalties collected be re-invested into local village councils for infrastructure and health initiatives. By transitioning from a primitive, revenue-only collection mindset to an asset-management approach, the state can secure its infrastructural self-reliance without bankrupting its environmental capital. The objective is to establish a system where mineral extraction funds long-term regional development rather than short-term private gain.

2. A group of Village Councils from the Kolasib district has submitted a joint petition expressing serious concerns over the depletion of the local water table and heavy air pollution caused by stone-crushing units operating near their agricultural lands. Write an official reply as the Assistant Controller of Mines to the Chairman of the Joint Village Council Committee. Acknowledge their grievances, detail the immediate regulatory steps your office is taking (such as directing operators to install water sprinklers and dust containment hoods), and explain how funds will be deployed to restore the local water sources and community infrastructure. Sign as XYZ. (10)

3. Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

The mining and processing of minerals provides us with the building blocks required to form much of the infrastructure needed to support modern societies. However, the process of mining remains intense and invasive, and operations often leave environmental impacts on the local surroundings as well as wider implications for the environmental health of the planet.

Mining and mineral processing operations often have high water footprints as many stages require the use of water. Examples include dust mitigation, removing soluble particles, sieving and separation processes, and in creating tailings dams for waste management. High water use in mining operations can lead to reduced access for local people to uncontaminated freshwater supplies and can result in a local area suffering from water stress. However, compared to other industries, mining has a relatively small water usage and often a large fraction of the water used is saline so it does not have much use in other industries or domestically.

Another issue related to environmental pollution caused by mining is that of leakages of mining tailings. Mining tailings are the materials left behind after the economically valuable fraction of material has been extracted. Modern mining programmes often aim to remove these harmful but valuable chemicals to reuse for further mineral separation. In addition to improving efficiency and cutting costs, this minimises the risk of environmental damage by reducing the toxicity of the tailings.

Overall, when considering the environmental ramifications of mining, it is important to weigh up the social and environmental damages caused by extracting the minerals against the benefits gained from the use of the final product. Mining of further resources is required to support the growing global population, but it should allow for the creation of green infrastructure and renewable energy generation. It is vital that governments and companies continue to innovate to create clean mining technologies with strict environmental regulations which will enable the mining industry to pave the way for a sustainable and hopeful future.

1. What are the ways in which water is used in mining? (2)
2. How can environmental damage from mining tailings be reduced? (2)
3. What can governments and companies do to mitigate the environmental damages caused by mining? (2)
4. Find words in the passage that has the same meaning as: (4×1=4)
 - (a) Intrusive
 - (b) Saltwater
 - (c) Consequences
 - (d) Pioneer

PART- B
(66 Marks)

All questions carry equal mark of 1.

This Section should be answered only on the OMR Response Sheet provided.

Notes regarding Negative Marking :

- (i) *There will be penalty (negative marking) for every wrong answer given by a candidate in the MCQ type questions.*
 - (ii) *For each question for which a wrong answer has been given by the candidate, one-third of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted as penalty.*
 - (iii) *If a candidate gives more than one answer to one question, it will be treated as wrong answer even if one of the given answers happens to be correct and there will be same penalty as above for that question.*
 - (iv) *If any question is left blank i.e. no answer is given by the candidate, there will be no penalty for that question.*
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Direction (Question Nos. 1 - 10): Answer the following questions as directed:

1. In the sentence, “*The regional committee met **weekly** to review the mining lease applications,*” what part of speech is the word ‘weekly’?
 - (a) Adjective
 - (b) Adverb
 - (c) Noun
 - (d) Conjunction
2. In the sentence, “*We must find a **fast** solution to the slope stability issue before the monsoon begins,*” what part of speech is the word ‘fast’?
 - (a) Adjective
 - (b) Adverb
 - (c) Verb
 - (d) Noun
3. In the sentence, “*The surveyor walked **past** the boundary pillar without noticing the structural damage,*” what part of speech is the word ‘past’?
 - (a) Adverb
 - (b) Noun
 - (c) Preposition
 - (d) Verb

4. In the sentence, “*The department decided to **house** the new core samples in the main laboratory,*” what part of speech is the word ‘house’?
- (a) Noun (b) Adjective
(c) Verb (d) Preposition
5. In the sentence, “***Neither** the operator nor the safety engineer cleared the quarry site for blasting,*” what part of speech is the word ‘neither’?
- (a) Conjunction (b) Pronoun
(c) Adjective (d) Adverb
6. In which of the following sentences is the word “iron” used as an adjective?
- (a) The miners extracted high-grade iron from the structural belt.
(b) You need to iron out the discrepancies in the annual mineral report.
(c) The safety inspector wore an iron helmet during the field audit.
(d) Iron is a vital resource for heavy industrial manufacturing.
7. In which of the following sentences is the word “before” used as a subordinating conjunction?
- (a) I have visited the Tlawng river quarry before.
(b) The candidate stood before the selection board for his interview.
(c) Clean the core drill thoroughly before you store it in the shed.
(d) The administration issued the warning two days before.
8. Read the sentence: “*The team completed the environmental audit fairly quickly.*” What does the adverb “fairly” modify?
- (a) The noun “audit” (b) The verb “completed”
(c) The adverb “quickly” (d) The adjective “environmental”
9. In the sentence, “*Both plans look operationally viable, but the second one is safer,*” the word “Both” functions as a/an:
- (a) Adjective (b) Pronoun
(c) Conjunction (d) Verb
10. In the sentence, “*The local administration handled the public protest politely yet firmly,*” the word “politely” is an:
- (a) Adverb of Time (b) Adverb of Degree
(c) Adverb of Manner (d) Adverb of Place

Direction (Question Nos. 11 - 15): The sentences below are divided into 3 segments, A, B and C. Identify which part of the sentence contains an error based on the incorrect usage of a part of speech:

11. “The newly appointed inspector / (A) / handled the delicate border dispute / (B) / high professional and with absolute tact.” / (C)
- (a) Segment (A) contains an incorrect adverb.
(b) Segment (B) contains an incorrect preposition.
(c) Segment (C) contains an incorrect use of adjective.
(d) No Error; the sentence is structurally perfect.

12. “The engineering team could not / (A) / operate the heavy core drill machinery / (B) / because it was running bad today.” / (C)
- (a) Segment (A) contains a faulty modal verb.
 - (b) Segment (B) contains an incorrect compound noun.
 - (c) Segment (C) contains an incorrect use of adjective.
 - (d) No Error; the sentence is structurally perfect.
13. The leaseholder complied / (A) / to all the statutory environmental rules / (B) / during the initial extraction phase. / (C)
- (a) Segment (A) contains an incorrect past-participle structure.
 - (b) Segment (B) is incorrect because ‘complied’ requires the preposition ‘with’ instead of ‘to’.
 - (c) Segment (C) contains a faulty temporal prepositional phrase.
 - (d) No Error; the sentence is structurally sound.
14. Between you and I, / (A) / the structural design of the stone-crushing unit / (B) / appears structurally flawed. / (C)
- (a) Segment (A) contains an incorrect use of pronoun.
 - (b) Segment (B) contains an incorrect compound noun modifier.
 - (c) Segment (C) contains an incorrect adverbial modifier.
 - (d) No Error; the sentence is structurally sound.
15. The sudden drop in mineral royalties / (A) / will adverse affect / (B) / the development funds allocated to the local village council. / (C)
- (a) Segment (A) contains an incorrect prepositional link.
 - (b) Segment (B) contains an incorrect use of adjective to modify the verb.
 - (c) Segment (C) contains a faulty passive construction.
 - (d) No Error; the sentence is structurally sound.

Direction (Question Nos. 16 - 25): Choose the correct option as instructed:

16. In the sentence, “The department issued a formal notice to the leaseholder,” what category of adjective is the word ‘formal’?
- (a) Adjective of Quality
 - (b) Demonstrative Adjective
 - (c) Distributive Adjective
 - (d) Quantitative Adjective
17. In the sentence, “The field office is located near the active quarry site,” what part of speech is the word ‘near’?
- (a) Conjunction
 - (b) Preposition
 - (c) Verb
 - (d) Adverb
18. In the sentence, “The extraction process was extremely chaotic due to unscientific planning,” what does the adverb ‘extremely’ modify?
- (a) The noun “process”
 - (b) The verb “was”
 - (c) The adjective “chaotic”
 - (d) The noun “planning”

19. Which of the target words in the choices below functions as a Gerund?
- (a) The inspector is '**checking**' the transport passes at the border checkpost.
 - (b) '**Blasting**' requires a valid statutory permit from the mining controller.
 - (c) The '**shattered**' shale layers made structural drilling highly unpredictable.
 - (d) She will be '**running**' the drone volumetric survey tomorrow morning.
20. In the sentence, "The Assistant Controller found 'few' errors in the structural design blueprint," the word 'few' is a/an:
- (a) Indefinite Pronoun
 - (b) Adjective of Quantity
 - (c) Adverb of Degree
 - (d) Demonstrative Adjective
21. In the sentence, "The heavy dumpers move slowly along the steep hill paths," the word 'slowly' is an:
- (a) Adverb of Time
 - (b) Adverb of Degree
 - (c) Adverb of Manner
 - (d) Adverb of Place
22. In the sentence, "The village council raised concerns about the heavy dust pollution," what is the structural function of the word 'about'?
- (a) It modifies the verb "raised" as an adverb.
 - (b) It connects the noun phrase "the heavy dust pollution" to the rest of the sentence as a preposition.
 - (c) It links two independent clauses as a coordinating conjunction.
 - (d) It stands alone as an abstract naming word.
23. In the sentence, "The safety parameters must be checked daily by the site engineers," the word 'daily' functions as an:
- (a) Adjective of Quality
 - (b) Adverb of Frequency
 - (c) Noun of Time
 - (d) Coordinating Conjunction
24. In the sentence, "The heavy rain caused the soil overburden to liquefy, so the operations were suspended," the word 'so' is a/an:
- (a) Adverb of Degree
 - (b) Preposition of Reason
 - (c) Coordinating Conjunction
 - (d) Abstract Noun
25. In the sentence, "The leaseholder must submit each of the monthly extraction logs by Friday," the word 'each' functions as a/an:
- (a) Distributive Adjective
 - (b) Distributive Pronoun
 - (c) Adverb of Frequency
 - (d) Relative Pronoun

Direction (Question Nos. 26 - 35): Rewrite the sentences by changing the part of speech of the underlined word as indicated:

26. She faced the approaching army bravely. (to Noun)
- (a) She faced the approaching army in a brave way
 - (b) She faced the approaching army with bravery
 - (c) She faced the approaching army with braveness
 - (d) She bravely faced the approaching army

27. I do not think I have the strength to continue. (to Adjective)
- (a) I do not think I am strengthened enough to continue
 - (b) I do not think I can continue strongly
 - (c) I do not think I am strong enough to continue
 - (d) I do not think I have the strongness to continue
28. He offered me a proposal to deal directly with the suppliers. (to Verb)
- (a) He proposed that we deal directly with the suppliers
 - (b) He offered me a proposal to deal directly with the suppliers
 - (c) He proposalled to deal directly with the suppliers
 - (d) He offered me a proposition to deal directly with the suppliers
29. She gave a beautiful smile at the reporters. (to Adverb)
- (a) She gave a smile of great beauty at the reporters
 - (b) She gave a beauteous smile at the reporters
 - (c) She beauteously smiled at the reporters
 - (d) She smiled beautifully at the reporters
30. It is true that I do not deserve her. (to Noun)
- (a) I truly do not deserve her
 - (b) It is truthful that I do not deserve her
 - (c) It is the truth that I do not deserve her
 - (d) I truthfully do not deserve her

Direction (Question Nos. 31 - 35): Answer the following questions as instructed:

31. "Read the following sentence and choose the correct degree of the target word:
"Of all the heavy aggregate transport trucks deployed at the site, the new dumper runs the **most efficiently**."
- (a) Comparative Degree of an Adjective
 - (b) Positive Degree of an Adverb
 - (c) Superlative Degree of an Adjective
 - (d) Superlative Degree of an Adverb
32. Read the following sentence and choose the correct class of the target pronoun:
"The safety engineer **who** authorized the blasting operation has submitted his field log."
- (a) Relative Pronoun
 - (b) Interrogative Pronoun
 - (c) Demonstrative Pronoun
 - (d) Reflexive Pronoun
33. Read the following sentence and choose the specific category of the target adverb:
"The Assistant Controller of Mines **seldom** issues an immediate suspension notice without a prior written warning."
- (a) Adverb of Manner
 - (b) Adverb of Degree
 - (c) Adverb of Frequency
 - (d) Adverb of Place

34. Read the following sentence and choose the correct degree of the target adjective:

“The technical committee concluded that this was the **most apparent** structural violation recorded this year.”

- (a) Positive Degree
- (b) Comparative Degree
- (c) Superlative Degree
- (d) Absolute Indefinite Degree

35. Read the following sentence and choose the specific category of the target adverb:

“The technical task force set up its portable laboratory testing equipment **there**, right next to the core drill unit.”

- (a) Adverb of Place
- (b) Adverb of Time
- (c) Adverb of Manner
- (d) Adverb of Certainty

Direction (Question Nos. 36 - 40): Choose the word that best fits the sentence both grammatically and contextually.

36. Because the steep terrain makes physical inspection exceptionally difficult, the department must rely on drone surveys to _____ the exact boundaries of the remote mountain leases.

- (a) obfuscate
- (b) delineate
- (c) reciprocate
- (d) condone

37. Rather than implementing permanent engineering modifications, the contractor offered only a _____, short-term fix to the crumbling retaining wall.

- (a) perennial
- (b) makeshift
- (c) definitive
- (d) meticulous

38. The revenue records showed a massive discrepancy, indicating that illegal transport networks had been systematically _____ state mineral royalties for years.

- (a) siphoning
- (b) bolstering
- (c) condensing
- (d) exonerating

39. To avoid unscientific extraction, the state’s updated mineral master plan mandates a _____ approach that prioritizes long-term resource conservation over immediate profit.

- (a) reckless
- (b) sporadic
- (c) judicious
- (d) dogmatic

40. The village council’s written petition was highly _____, listing dozens of specific dates and environmental violations caused by the nearby crushing units.

- (a) ambiguous
- (b) superficial
- (c) articulate
- (d) redundant

Direction (Question Nos. 41 - 46): Choose the correct meaning of the following idioms and phrases:

41. Bite off more than you can chew:

- (a) To try to do more than you can manage
- (b) To excel beyond one’s expectations
- (c) to let go of things that no longer serve you
- (d) to receive no acknowledgement for hard work

42. To be under the weather:

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|--|
| (a) To make yourself less noticeable | (b) To make enough money to be comfortable |
| (c) To feel ill or unwell | (d) To feel lonely or melancholy for no reason |

43. To be in the red:

- | | |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| (a) To be guilty of a crime | (b) To attract unwanted attention |
| (c) To be lucky all the time | (d) To be in financial debt |

44. A man of straw:

- | | |
|--|--|
| (a) a person who is weak, or lacks substance | (b) a person who can adapt to all situations |
| (c) a person without wealth or assets | (d) a light-hearted person |

45. to die in harness:

- | | |
|---|---|
| (a) To leave behind a lot of debt after death | (b) To leave behind a lot of wealth after death |
| (c) To die peacefully with a clear conscience | (d) To die while in service |

46. A litmus test:

- (a) A decisive test that provides a clear answer
- (b) A test that produces inconclusive results
- (c) A test that is doomed to end in failure
- (d) a test that heavily favours someone

Direction (Question Nos. 47 - 51) : Choose the correct term for the following definitions:

47. someone who completely abstains from drinking:

- | | |
|-------------------|--------------------|
| (a) teeter-totter | (b) prohibitionist |
| (c) teetotaler | (d) abstentist |

48. a word or practice that has gone out of use:

- | | |
|--------------|------------------|
| (a) obsolete | (b) obstreperous |
| (c) abolish | (d) admonish |

49. to cause someone to be celebrated or remembered forever:

- | | |
|--------------|-----------------|
| (a) immolate | (b) mortarium |
| (c) memoriam | (d) immortalize |

50. a state where no law and order exists:

- | | |
|-----------------|----------------|
| (a) apocalyptic | (b) tyranny |
| (c) anarchy | (d) dysmorphia |

51. a decision or opinion that is completely agreed upon by everyone in a group:

- | | |
|---------------|----------------|
| (a) Eponymous | (b) Unanimous |
| (c) anonymous | (d) ubiquitous |

Directions (Question Nos. 52 - 56): Choose the correct antonym of the following:

52. Arbitrary:

- | | |
|-------------|--------------|
| (a) Random | (b) Rational |
| (c) unclear | (d) unique |

53. Convivial:

- | | |
|----------------|--------------|
| (a) Illegal | (b) Friendly |
| (c) unsociable | (d) lawful |

54. Inevitable:

- | | |
|-------------|------------------|
| (a) Delible | (b) Avoidable |
| (c) edible | (d) recognizable |

55. Erstwhile:

- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| (a) Former | (b) Permanent |
| (c) momentary | (d) current |

56. Compel:

- | | |
|--------------|-------------|
| (a) Dissuade | (b) Request |
| (c) force | (d) deny |

Directions (Question Nos. 57 - 61): Combine the following sentences as indicated:

57. It is very hot. One cannot go out. (use an infinitive)

- | | |
|---|-----------------------------------|
| (a) Being hot, we cannot go out | (b) It is too hot to go out |
| (c) It is very hot, therefore, we cannot go out | (d) We cannot go out as it is hot |

58. He passed the test. It was very fortunate. (use an Adverb)

- (a) Fortunately, he passed the test
- (b) He passed the test with great fortune
- (c) It was very fortunate that he passed the test
- (d) He was to fortunate to not have passed the test

59. John is my friend. He is a captain in the army. (use Noun phrase in apposition)

- (a) John is my friend who is a captain in the army
- (b) A captain in the army, John is my friend
- (c) John, my friend, is a captain in the army
- (d) John is my friend as well as a captain in the army

60. I have sold my cow. It was red in colour. (using adjective clause)

- (a) My cow, red in colour, was sold
- (b) I have sold my red cow
- (c) I have sold my cow which was red in colour
- (d) I have sold a cow that is red

61. Do what you like. Do not bother me. (use adversative conjunction)

- (a) Do what you like, but don't bother me (b) Do what you like and don't bother me
- (c) Do what you like, therefore don't bother me (d) Do what you like or don't bother me

Direction (Question Nos. 62 - 66): Select the option that is completely free of grammatical, syntax, and punctuation errors:

62. Which sentence correctly handles subject-verb agreement with compound structures?

- (a) Neither the field surveyor nor the structural engineers is satisfied with the stability of the opencast benches.
- (b) Neither the field surveyor nor the structural engineers are satisfied with the stability of the opencast benches.
- (c) Neither the field surveyor nor the structural engineers was satisfied with the stability of the opencast benches.
- (d) Neither the field surveyor nor the structural engineers has been satisfied with the stability of the opencast benches.

63. Which sentence displays correct word usage regarding "effect" and "affect"?

- (a) The unscientific dumping of aggregate waste will adverse effect the local water table within a few months.
- (b) The unscientific dumping of aggregate waste will adversely effect the local water table within a few months.
- (c) The unscientific dumping of aggregate waste will adversely affect the local water table within a few months.
- (d) The unscientific dumping of aggregate waste will have an adverse affect on the local water table within a few months.

64. Which sentence handles the relative pronouns "who" and "whom" correctly?

- (a) Whom did the technical committee appoint as the chief safety officer for the new sandstone project?
- (b) Who did the technical committee appoint as the chief safety officer for the new sandstone project?
- (c) To who did the technical committee hand over the confidential mining boundary blueprints?
- (d) Whom was designated by the technical committee as the chief safety officer for the new sandstone project?

65. Which sentence uses possessive punctuation flawlessly?

- (a) The three quarrys' common access road was heavily damaged by the overloaded transport dumpers.
- (b) The three quarries' common access road was heavily damaged by the overloaded transport dumpers.
- (c) The three quarry's common access road was heavily damaged by the overloaded transport dumpers.
- (d) The three quarries common access road was heavily damaged by the overloaded transport dumpers.

66. Which sentence showcases accurate use of tense?

- (a) When the inspector reached the drilling site, he discovered that the workers already fled the area.
- (b) When the inspector reached the drilling site, he discovered that the workers had already fled the area.
- (c) When the inspector reaches the drilling site, he discovered that the workers already fled the area.
- (d) When the inspector reached the drilling site, he discovers that the workers had already fled the area.

* * * * *